H. Sherry Zhang

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Appointment

Feb 2024 - Present **Postdoctoral Fellow** **University of Texas at Austin**
Supervisor: Prof. Roger Peng

Education

Feb 2020 - Dec 2023 **PhD in Statistics** **Monash University, Australia**
Thesis: *New tools for visualising and explaining multivariate spatio-temporal data*
Supervisors: Prof. Dianne Cook, Dr. Patricia Menéndez, Dr. Nicolas Langrené, and Dr. Ursula Laa

Feb 2016 - Dec 2019 **Bachelor of Commerce with Honours** **Monash University, Australia**
Econometrics and Business Analytics, First Class Honours (H1)
Thesis: *Exploration of judicial facial expression in videos of legal proceedings*
Supervisors: Prof. Dianne Cook and Prof. Russell Smyth

Awards

2026 **ENVR Workshop Travel Support**, *ENVR workshop, Houston, TX*

2026 **IMS New Researcher Travel Award**, *New Researcher Conference, Amherst, MA*

2025 **KODAQS guest researcher visit program at LMU Munich Germany**, *2,500 EUR*

2025 **Winner of the JSM Data Challenge Expo**

2024 **John M. Chambers Statistical Software Award**, *ASA Section of Statistical Computing and Statistical Graphics: 2,000 USD. Awarded for the R package, cubble, which introduces a new data structure for spatio-temporal data and provides ggplot2 extensions for creating glyph maps.*

2023 **Posit Opportunity Scholar**, *invitation to attend Posit::conf(2023) with all expenses covered*

2022 **People's Choice Award**, ECSS Miniconference, Statistical Society of Australia

2020 - 2023 **Postgraduate (PhD) Research Scholarship**, CSIRO Data61

2020 - 2023 **Co-Funded Graduate Research Scholarship**, Monash Business School

2020 **Dean's Honours List**, Monash Business School

2019 **Summer Vacation Research Scholarship**, Monash University

Publications

1. Po, M., Yang, S. N., **Zhang, H. S.**, & Cook, D. (2026). Sugarglider: Create Glyph-Maps of Spatiotemporal Data. *The R Journal*, *18*(3), 286–304. https://doi.org/10.32614/RJ-2026-050
2. **Zhang, H. S.**, Cook, D., Langrené, N., & Leung, J. W. Y. (2026). Squintability and Other Metrics for Assessing Projection Pursuit Indexes and Guiding Optimization Choices. *Journal of Computational and Graphical Statistics*. https://doi.org/10.1080/10618600.2026.2614076
3. **Zhang, H. S.**, Peng, R. D. (2026). Inside Out: Externalizing Assumptions in Data Analysis as Validation Checks. *Journal of Data Science*. https://doi.org/10.6339/25-JDS1206
4. **Zhang, H. S.**, Cook, D., Laa, U., Langrené, N., & Menéndez, P. (2025). A Tidy Framework and Infrastructure to Systematically Assemble Spatio-temporal Indexes from Multivariate Data. *Journal of Computational and Graphical Statistics*, 1-19. https://doi.org/10.1080/10618600.2024.2374960
5. **Zhang, H. S.**, Cook, D., Laa, U., Langrené, N., & Menéndez, P. (2024). cubble: An R package for organizing and wrangling multivariate spatio-temporal data. *Journal of Statistical Software*, *110*, 1-27. https://doi.org/10.18637/jss.v110.i07
6. Lee, S., Cook, D., Silva, N. da, Laa, U., Spyrison, N., Wang, E., & **Zhang, H. S.** (2022). The state-of-the-art on tours for dynamic visualization of high-dimensional data. *WIREs Computational Statistics*, *14*(4), e1573. https://doi.org/10.1002/wics.1573

7. **Zhang, H. S.**, Cook, D., Laa, U., Langrené, N., & Menéndez, P. (2021). Visual Diagnostics for Constrained Optimisation with Application to Guided Tours. *The R Journal*, *13*(2), 624–641. https://doi.org/10.32614/RJ-2021-105

Under review or revision:

8. **Zhang, H. S.**, Peng, R. D. (2026). Code availability is not enough: schemas for documenting and extending data analysis. *Under review at The Annals of Applied Statistics*

9. **Zhang, H. S.**, Reynolds, E., & Robbins, J. (2026). The ggplot2 extension ecosystem: an overview for users and developers. *Invited submission to WIREs Computational Statistics - minor revision.* https://github.com/jtr13/extensions-review

10. Coleman, S., **Zhang, H. S.**, Lucchesi, L., & Roy, S. (2026). Exploring the periodicity of flight patterns. *Invited submission to the CHANCE magazine - minor revision.*

11. **Zhang, H. S.**, Peng, R. D. (2025). An LLM-based Pipeline for Understanding Decision Choices in Data Analysis from Published Literature. https://github.com/huizezhang-sherry/paper-decisions

Software Activities

Package maintainer (primary author):

tidyindex	A general data pipeline for computing indexes
cubble	A data structure for organizing and wrangling spatio-temporal data
ferrn	Visual diagnostics plots for projection pursuit guided tour optimisation
tines	Schemas for documenting and extending data analysis with LLMs

Package contributor:

rj	Tools to help the associate editors with the reviewing process of the R journal
rjtools	Tools for authors to write, check, and submit articles to the R Journal
tourr	Tour methods for multivariate data visualisation

Other activities:

2024-now	maintainer of CRAN task view: Dynamic Visualizations
2024	reviewer of ROpenSci software peer review
2024	reviewer of John M. Chambers Statistical Software Award 2025
2025	contributor to fix bug in base R on array max.print

Teaching and Supervision

Instructor for UT Austin undergraduate coursework:

2025/26 Fall SDS322E Elements of Data Sciences: https://huizezhang-sherry.github.io/SDS322E/

Research supervision:

2024	Google Summer of Code (GSoC) R Projects: Maliny Po: master student, now PhD student, Monash University Nathan Yang: undergraduate, Duke Univeristy
2024	Summer research project: Walter Wang: PhD student at UT Austin

TA for Monash undergraduate and graduate coursework:

2021, 2022	ETC5512 Wild Caught Data
2020, 2021	ETC5521 Exploratory Data Analysis
2019, 2020	ETC1010/ETC5510 Introduction to Data Analysis

Instructor for workshops:

2023 Apr	Switching between space and time: Spatio-temporal analysis with cubble, R Ladies Vienna
2022 Dec	Wrangling spatio-temporal data with R, WOMBAT link

2022 Sep Switching between space and time: Spatio-temporal analysis with cubble, R Ladies Melbourne

Service

1. Associate editor for the R Journal, 2026 -
2. Program Chair (Elect), ASA Section of Statistical Graphics, 2026 (2025)
3. Journal review: R Journal, Journal of Data Science, The Australian & New Zealand Journal of Statistics, and Ecology and Evolution
4. Software review: ROpenSci and John M. Chambers Statistical Software Award review panel, 2024
5. Seminar organiser: Monash NUMBATs, 2022

Talks and Posters

2026, Oct	ENVR Workshop	*Houston, TX*
2026, Jun	UseR! 2026	*Warsaw, Poland*
2026, Jun	LMU SODA Lab Group Seminar	*Munich, Germany*
2025 Jun	NYU-LMU-Workshop Making Data Work: Tools for Better Statistical Practice	*Munich, Germany*
2025 Aug	Joint Statistical Meeting (JSM)	*Nashville, USA*
2025 May	Symposium on Data Science and Statistics	*Salt Lake City, USA*
2024 Dec	University of Nebraska-Lincoln Graphic Group	*virtual*
2024 Oct	UT Austin SDS Department Seminar	*Austin, USA*
2024 Sep	Intl. Conf. on Trends & Perspectives in Linear Stats. Inference (LinStat 2024)	*Poprad, Slovakia*
2024 Aug	Computational Statistics (COMPSTAT 2024)	*Giessen, Germany*
2024 Aug	Joint Statistical Meeting (JSM)	*Portland, USA*
2024 Aug	John M. Chambers Statistical Software Award Talk	*Portland, USA*
2024 Jan	Humboldt University of Berlin, Faculty of Economics	*Germany*
2023 Dec	Computational and Methodological Statistics (CMStatistics 2023)	*Berlin, Germany*
2023 Sep	Monash Research Tools Workshop	*Melbourne, Australia*
2023 May	University of Münster, Institute for Geoinformatics	*Germany*
2023 Feb	The Australian Spatial Econometrics and Statistics Workshop	*Melbourne, Australia*
2023 Apr	Maynooth University, Department of Mathematics and Statistics	*Ireland*
2022 Nov	CANSSI Ontario Statistical Software Conference	*virtual*
2022 Nov	Early Career and Student Statisticians Miniconference	*virtual*
2022 Jun	UseR! 2022	*virtual*
2021 Jul	UseR! 2021	*virtual*

Media Coverage

2023 Monash Graduate research impact: Crunching the numbers: How new research has revealed the hidden truth behind indexes

Referees

1. **Roger D. Peng**, Postdoc Supervisor, roger.peng@austin.utexas.edu, Professor of Statistics, Department of Statistics and Data Sciences at the University of Texas at Austin, Texas, USA
2. **Dianne H. Cook**, PhD Thesis Advisor, dicook@monash.edu, Professor of Statistics, Department of Econometrics and Business Statistics at Monash University, Australia
3. **Nicolas Langrené**, PhD Thesis Advisor, nicolaslangrene@bnbu.edu.cn, Associate Professor in the UIC Financial Mathematics Programme at Beijing Normal-Hong Kong Baptist University, Zhuhai, Guangdong, China